

Stop eating junk food.

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 08, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/XM9ripccSgg> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter runs through six common junk food cravings and offers a practical, protein-focused swap for each — keeping the satisfaction while cutting empty calories and sugar.

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🍪 Swap 1: Cookies → Protein Bar 0:00

- Craving something sweet like a cookie?
 - Reach for a **protein bar** instead
 - Satisfies the sweet craving while delivering protein rather than empty sugar calories

🍟 Swap 2: Chips → Roasted Almonds 0:04

- Craving chips?
 - Eat roasted almonds instead
 - Provides a crunchy, satisfying texture similar to chips
 - Adds healthy fats and protein rather than refined carbs

🥩 Swap 3: Salty Snacks (Pretzels/Popcorn) → Beef Jerky 0:07

- Craving something salty like pretzels or popcorn?
 - Choose beef jerky
 - It's salty — hits the same craving — and also delivers a meaningful protein hit

🥤 Swap 4: Soda → Diet Soda / Zero-Calorie Energy Drink 0:11

- Craving soda?
 - Drink diet soda — Brandon's personal favorite is **Coke Zero**
 - He describes himself as a "big aspartame fan" (no concern over the sweetener)
- Craving an energy drink?
 - Go ahead and drink one — just make sure it's a **zero-calorie energy drink**



Swap 5: Caramel Frappuccino → Two Shots of Espresso Over Ice 0:22

- Craving a caramel Frappuccino from a coffee run?
 - Brandon's blunt advice (directed humorously at men): skip it, "slap yourself, do some push-ups, toughen up"
 - The actual swap: **two shots of espresso over ice**
 - Zero sugar, minimal calories, still provides caffeine



Swap 6: Double Cheeseburger or Milkshake → Bunless Burger / Grilled Chicken / Protein Shake 0:44

- Craving a double cheeseburger?
 - Brandon's personal approach (keto): order the double cheeseburger and eat it **without the bun**
 - He does this every time he takes his son to McDonald's
 - If not keto: get a **grilled chicken sandwich** instead
- Craving a milkshake post-workout?
 - Swap it for a **protein shake**
 - Rationale: consuming protein after a workout is highly beneficial for muscle recovery; a milkshake provides sugar and fat but little protein